GG-D-223b

MAY 5, 1958

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GG–D–00223a (GSA–FSS)
April 3, 1957, and
Fed. Spec. GG–D–223
December 4, 1947

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DEPRESSOR, TONGUE, METAL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. — This specification covers a metal tongue depressor used to press down the tongue during examination of the mouth and throat.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Type.*—Metal tongue depressors in accordance with this specification shall be of one type as specified hereinafter.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

GG–I–526 — Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–P–12902 — Packaging of Surgical, Dental, and Veterinary Instruments, Diagnostic Equipment, and Related Items.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.—The tongue depressor shall be of corrosion-resisting steel conforming to the requirements for class 2, composition G of Federal Specification GG–I–526.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2 Design.—The tongue depressors shall be of the conventional Weder type, as illustrated in figure 1, consisting of a stamped steel blade and handle of one-piece construction, suitably formed, and containing serrations to depress and maneuver the tongue.

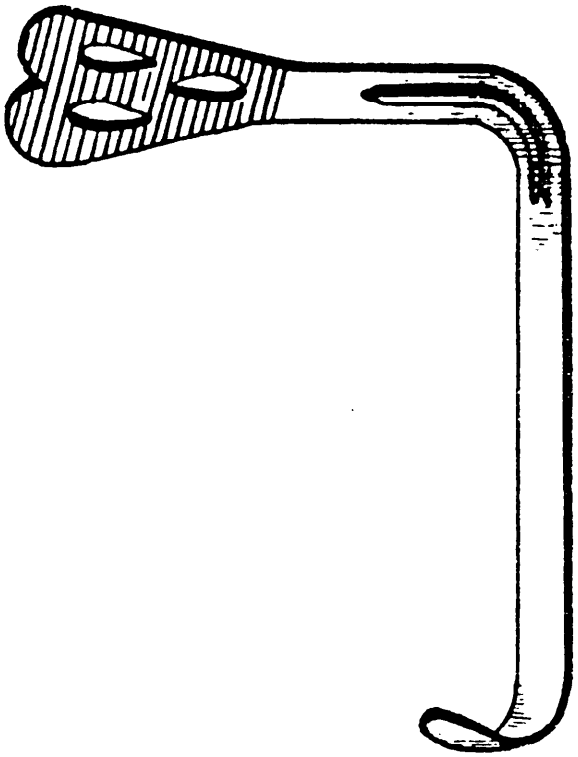


FIGURE 1.—Weder-type metal tongue depressor.

3.3 Construction and dimensions.

3.3.1 *Blade.*—The blade shall be well flattened, properly fenestrated, and the edges shall be properly rounded. It shall be of the greatest width near the distal end of the blade. The distal end shall be serrated for $1\frac{1}{2} \pm \frac{1}{8}$ inch; serrations shall be $\frac{1}{16} \pm \frac{1}{64}$ inch apart (see figure 1). The blade shall be $3\frac{3}{4} \pm \frac{1}{4}$ inches long by $0.075 \pm .005$ inch thick.

3.3.2 *Handle.*—The handle shall be set approximately at a right angle with the general plane of the blade $4\frac{1}{2} \pm \frac{1}{4}$ inches long, with the bottom portion curved to form an arc (see figure 1). It shall be shaped in such a manner as to furnish a comfortable and adequate grip.

3.4 Finish.—The tongue depressors shall be mirror-finished on all surfaces in accordance with Federal Specification GG–I–526, with the exception of the serrated portion.

3.5 Marking.—Each instrument shall be legibly and permanently stamped with the name or registered trade-mark of the manufacturer.

3.6 Workmanship.—The workmanship shall be first class in every respect. Instruments shall be free from harmful sharp edges, burs, pits, or other imperfections which affect their appearance or which may affect their serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.

4.1.1 *For visual examination.*—Sampling procedures for visual examination shall be conducted in accordance with the procedures set forth in Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.1.2 *For tests.*—Sample size for tests shall be as indicated for level L–2 in Appendix to Military Standard MIL–STD–105, except that the acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes, and a minimum of four samples shall be taken.

4.2 Inspection.—The inspector shall ascertain that the tongue depressors have been inspected and accepted in accordance with specification requirements.

4.3 Tests.—Testing shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of Federal Specification GG–I–526.

4.4 Supplier responsibilities for inspection.—The supplier shall be required to perform

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

examinations and tests to substantiate conformance of supplies to specification requirements. The examinations and tests shall be at the expense of the supplier. Suppliers shall have either adequate test facilities for executing tests, or shall make arrangements for the utilization of test facilities acceptable to the Government. Records of examinations and tests performed by the supplier shall be maintained by the supplier and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, for a period of two years after the delivery of the supplies to which the same relates. The supplier shall be responsible for compliance with all requirements of this specification, and all other technical requirements of the contract.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(The levels of Preservation, Packaging and Packing used are defined in Federal Standard No. 102.)

5.1 Packaging and packing.

5.1.1 *Unit of issue.* — One depressor, as specified, constitutes one unit.

5.1.2 *Packaging quantities.*—The number of units indicated in table I shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

TABLE I.—*Packaging quantities*

Federal Stock No.	Unit package	Intermediate package	Shipping container
6515-324-5205	1	12	288

5.1.2.1 *Packing variation permitted.* — If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 *Procedures.*—Packing and packaging shall be in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–12902 for the applicable procedure code number indicated in table II.

TABLE II.—*Procedures*

Level of protection	Procedure code No.
Level A	30
Level B	20

5.1.4 *Level C.* — The subject commodity shall be packaged and packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 *Military agencies.*—Marking shall be in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–12902, except that ASMPA stock number is not required.

5.2.2 *Civilian agencies.*

5.2.2.1 *Packages.*—Each package shall be plainly labeled with the name of the item, quantity contained, and the name of the manufacturer or contractor.

5.2.2.2 *Shipping containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the item and quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, the number of the contract or order, and the gross weight.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Purchasers should exercise any options offered herein. (See 5.1.2, 5.1.3 and 5.2.2.2.)

6.2 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 This specification covers only the types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity as generally purchased by the Federal Government, and is not intended to include all types, etc., which are commercially available.

6.4 **Transportation description.**—Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Surgical instruments, not otherwise indexed by name.
(Metal tongue depressors)

Carload minimum weight 10,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor volume minimum weight 10,000 pounds.

6.5 This specification covers the following item appearing in the Armed Services Medical Stock List:

6515–324–5205—DEPRESSOR, TONGUE, METAL, WEDER.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—M
Navy—Md
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.